MUCH IS BEING MADE TODAY of the new Ram mandir as a political tool. As such, it creates a new vision and mission around the BJP regime. It portrays it both as a theological and technocratic exercise but, despite all the folklore and the conscious semiotic advertisement, the new Ram mandir, while evoking memory, lacks the full power of myth. The BJP damaged the myth by pretending to give it a historical literalness and, in doing so, it damaged the sense of the social. The first acts of this will be successful but, in the long run, it will be futile. To call it a new kind of resurgence does not fit history but advertising. This is not a Bhakti movement of any kind, this is an attempt to use religion instrumentally. The syncretic power of religion, the dialogicity, is lost. The current story lacks the subtlety and suppleness of a narrative. It sounds more like a diktat.



ANI



"Religion has been instrumentalised for political goals"

It's definitely a triumphant moment for political Hinduism and its advocates. This renewed confidence will manifest itself in the further Hindutvaisation in society. From the mid-1980s, religion very clearly has been instrumentalised for political goals. Over the years, this has built up a public emotiveness, which was near absent earlier, among Hindus. This emotional connect has grown with the expansion of electronic and social media. Hindus today increasingly identify with the deity Ram.

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"This is a global celebration of Sanatana Dharma culture"

JEFFREY ARMSTRONG
Vancouver-based Indic scholar

THIS IS AN EXCITING time for the culture of Bharat, a 'planet-wide Vedic renaissance', where the construction of grand temples in and outside India signifies a revival and global celebration of the ancient Sanatana Dharma culture. It should not be viewed merely through a superficial political lens. This is an opportunity for Indians to share the greatness of their culture, to lead the world by example rather than succumb to petty infighting. One must remember that the Ram temple is where the 'purna avatar' Shri Ram first appeared, and thus must not be used for political purposes, as its essence is rooted in profound universal wisdom, global harmony and promoting tolerance.